Teacher and cover plan

Year A | Autumn 2 · Week 1 | 3 November 2026

Add and reset two score variables

40 minutes. GROW. A pair, with one device each or a shared device and turn-taking. Formative lesson for the unit award; Week 7 is the assessing lesson.

Term theme

Identity & Belonging: clear, fair start rules make a shared maze project welcoming for every player.

Careers

Software testers check that counters and displays reset cleanly before a new user starts.

Learning and evidence

I can create two named score variables in my maze project and set both to zero on start.

I created two named score variables.

I set both score variables to zero on start.

I placed both readouts clear of the maze path.

I tested the start reset from a non-zero value.

I reopened my saved file and checked the script.

Prepare before pupils arrive

Open the lesson page or editable slides. Test variable creation and set-to-zero blocks in the block editor. Prepare the approved practice folder with the clean two-level starter maze file. Print the two fictional project cards, chosen routes and individual evidence slips. Do not display real personal files.

Kit for two: up to two devices, display, two project cards, two route sheets, two evidence slips and pens. A paper fallback uses the same project cards and variable planning frame. Keep the Autumn 1 maze files unchanged.

Lesson sequence

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Term theme: Identity & Belonging. Careers: checking counters and displays in software testing.

Minutes	Stage	What to do
0-3	Arrival	Recall the Autumn 1 maze start-and-save routine. Slides 1-2.
3-7	Starter	Compare two start scripts. Explain which gives a fair start. Slide 3.
7-10	Model	Create two clearly named score variables. Slide 4.
10-13	Model	Attach two set-to-zero blocks under start and place readouts. Slide 5.
13-15	Words	Teach variable, initialise, reset and readout. Slide 6.
15-20	Together	Match reset blocks and readout rules to setup steps. Slide 7.
20-23	Check	Test the reset from a non-zero number and fix readout placement. Slide 8.
23-35	Task	Add and reset two score variables in individual maze files. Slides 9-13.
35-40	Exit	Check variables and saved files; respond to feedback. Slide 14.

Protect the core task

Prioritise creating two named score variables and attaching two set-to-zero blocks under the start event. Protect the saved-file check. The third round-count variable and v2 are optional stretch. If typing variable names is slow, use exact scribing and record it; the pupil still chooses the blocks and values.

Modelling and support

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Term theme and careers

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Model the variable setup

Open the starter maze project and select card A. Create two variables named FuelScore and HazardHits. Show how both readouts appear on the stage and how each variable appears in the block menu. Contrast clear names with vague labels.

On the player sprite start script, attach set FuelScore to 0 and set HazardHits to 0 directly beneath the start event. Check the drop-down on each block so both variables are initialised rather than setting the same variable twice. Drag the two stage readouts to the top corners clear of the maze walls.

Reset test

Set FuelScore to 5 to simulate points from an earlier turn, then trigger the start event. Ask a pupil to check that both readouts return to 0 and that the start pad is not covered. Model moving a readout box and explain why it helps.

Support and turn-taking

Offer one step at a time, processing time, quiet thinking or a short pause. Use the Supported planning frame without making choices for the pupil. With one device, switch builder and tester roles after six minutes. First pupil uses card A; second uses card B. Each has a distinct file. Record prompts, adult typing and scribing accurately.

Saving

Create W01_Variables inside ICT_Practice in the agreed area. Save as Maze_Score_A_v1 or Maze_Score_B_v1 with the native project extension supplied by the software. Save, close, reopen through the folder and run the start check. Retain v1 when saving an optional v2.

Checking learning and recording evidence

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Check	What must be observed
Variable names	Two distinct variables match the chosen fictional project card.
Start reset	Two set-to-zero blocks under start initialise both variables.
Stage readouts	Both readouts are visible and clear of the start zone and walls.
Reset test	Triggering start returns a non-zero test value back to zero.
Player choice	Pupil explains why resetting scores on start helps the player.
Saved work	The saved project opens and shows both variables and reset blocks.

Feedback and response

Give one specific success and one next-step prompt. Hear the pupil's response or read it back, then agree the next action. Record VF for verbal feedback, I for independent work, WS where support was used and NS+ for the next-step prompt. Use R only after a real response with an audience; written responses are in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Keep the actual support record.

Paper fallback

Choose card A or B and complete the variable names, start reset values and readout positions on the paper planning frame. This shows planning and explanation only. Mark digital variable creation and saving as not yet observed; complete those checks at the next available device session.

Privacy and progression

Use only the fictional project cards. Do not add real names, places or personal accounts. Do not publish pupil files. Week 2 updates scores from two maze events; Week 7 is the assessing lesson for the unit award. This week records formative progress.